TryHackMe Writeup: Pyramid of Pain

Field	Details
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Room	Pyramid of Pain
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Objective

Learn what the Pyramid of Pain is and how it ranks indicators by how painful they are for an attacker to change.

What I did, task by task

The concept

- The higher up the pyramid a defender can detect and block, the more it hurts the attacker, because they must change more to continue.

Levels of the pyramid

- Went through each level from the bottom to the top with examples of the indicators at that level.

Practical

- Applied the idea to a sample scenario and matched indicators to the right level of the pyramid.

The pyramid levels

Level (bottom to top)	Examples	Difficulty for attacker to change
Hash values	MD5, SHA1, SHA256 of malware files	Trivial
IP addresses	C2 server or scanning IPs	Easy
Domain names	Malicious or phishing domains	Simple
Host artifacts	Registry keys, dropped files, mutex	Annoying
Network artifacts	User-agent strings, URI patterns, C2 traffic patterns	Annoying
Tools	Malware, exploit kits, password crackers	Challenging
TTPs	Tactics, techniques and procedures	Tough

Key takeaways

- Blocking hashes is easy to do but easy for an attacker to bypass.

- Detecting behaviour (TTPs) is hard for an attacker to avoid, so it gives the most value.
- Good detection engineering should aim for the upper levels.

Why this matters for a SOC role

As a SOC analyst I will work with IOCs every day. This model helps me decide which indicators are worth blocking and which detections give lasting value.

Proof of completion

